



FOSTERING LASTING COLLABORATIONS BETWEEN
AFRICAN AND EUROPEAN CONTEMPORARY ART SCENES
THROUGH ARTIST RESIDENCIES AND EXHIBITION PROGRAMS



MIKHAEL SUBOTZKY- 2005



SAMUEL PATJE - 2024



KALOKI NYAMAI - 2017



KAGISO PAT MAUTLOA - C1995



WILLIAM KENTRIDGE - 2010

Our Purpose

SAFFCA's 'RAISON D'ÊTRE' is to facilitate a dialogue focused on artistic practice mainly between Africa and Europe through cross-residencies, while supporting and disseminating the contemporary creation of local artists, whether emerging, established or even sometimes represented in galleries. We defend an authentic anchoring of projects, close to artists, communities and local realities, so that each initiative remains faithful to the contexts from which it emanates.

"To practically answer the growing global interest for African Contemporary Art, we had to grab this opportunity to participate to the erection of a new structure of dialogue in between our two continents through multicultural conversations at the art making level.

"I am because you are". Pierre - cofounder of SAFFCA NPC & SAFFCA.EU



BENON LUTAAYA AT WORK

Since 2015, we have been developing sustainable connections between the African and European art scenes through residencies, exhibitions and transmission programs.

Building bridges between Africa and Europe through contemporary art.



BAMBOLWAMI SIBIYA

In South Africa, France and, since 2021, Brussels, we welcome numerous artists in residence every year and share their works at our events. Located in the prestigious setting of the Abbaye de La Cambre, in partnership with ENSAV La Cambre, we promote the meeting of internationally recognized creators, promising young artists and varied audiences.

Brussels, a cosmopolitan city, offers fertile ground for connecting cultures and broadening perspectives. Convinced that art is a universal language, we make transmission a central axis: it connects generations, nourishes dialogue and prepares the creation of tomorrow. In a changing world, Africa, with its youth and dynamism, occupies an essential place. Through initiatives such as SAFFCA, we are forging lasting links between the art scenes, building a common future based on creating, listening and sharing.

Our way

- Three pairs made of one African artist and one European artist for 3-month residencies at the ABBAYE of LA CAMBRE.

25 to 30 residencies of African and European artists in South Africa in one of our four partnering spaces (soon to become six).

- Studios made available for 10 to 12 months to 3 young artists who have just graduated from La Cambre. Studios made available to 3 or 4 other artists selected with SOFAM as part of our partnership.

- Two annual SALONS in Brussels: our SPRING SALON towards the end of May and our FALL SALON in November. A virtual catalogue is published, accessible by QR code, integrating the visibility of the sponsors. - Organization of a private 'preview' evening at the Abbey of La Cambre in the presence of the artists, followed by a public vernissage.

- SEED in Johannesburg and Cape Town every second year: 60 works by 60 African artists.

- Attribution of several prizes in partnership with ENSAV LA CAMBRE, ARBA in Brussels and LATITUDES in South Africa.

- SAFFCA Collection: A living collection of African and European works, constantly evolving.

- Exhibitions, talks, meetings, dinners, partnerships and multiple events in Brussels and South Africa, opening up fresh perspectives for contemporary art as a whole.

- Activity on social media mostly through Instagram with some 30 000 to 40 000 views per month and over 3 000 followers.



Testimonies



NINDYA BUCKTOWAR

"As an artist, I have a constant need to seek beauty in everything I encounter & experience, and Witklipfontein was incredibly fertile for this aspect of my artistic practice."

Nindya went to Witklipfontein



JOAO LADEIRA

"During the residency, what stood out above everything was the robust, invaluable insights and guidance I received from the sponsors as my art project progressed. This re-affirmed to me that art is an engaged practice."

Joao went to Entabeni Farm



BEA SARRIAS

Bea Sarrias from Spain quoted Willim Faulkner *"You cannot swim for new horizons until you have courage to lose sight of the shore."*

Bea Sarrias came to LA CAMBRE



MOUAD ELBISSAOUI IN BRUSSELS

Mouad Elbissaoui came in residency in LA CAMBRE in 2024 and worked for 3 months alongside Barbara Schroeder. He decided to submit the drawings made during his SAFFCA Residency to the Eeckman Art Prize. He won the prize and was exhibited in the Eeckman Solo Booth at Art On Paper.

ACTIVITY REPORT 09.2024-11.2025

Since September 2024, SAFFCA has continued to develop its mission of fostering dialogue between European and Southern African art scenes through a dynamic programme of residencies, exhibitions and public events in Brussels and South Africa.

Residencies in Brussels

Artists in studio at our space in Brussels: SAFFCA welcomed last year 6 artists for periods of 10 to 12 months, including Kamand Razavi, Fabiola Burgos, Tina Carlini, Arpy Gokceyan (on display at TAMAT BECRAFT Prize), Hammed Dehqan and Azad Eurdekian.

Since October 2025, they have been joined by Vittoria Toscana, Aline Forçain, Camille Rakotomalala, Clara Lehon and Hovic Der Sarkissian, the latter exhibited at the Boghossian Foundation. In January 2026, Céline Vahsen (currently in residence at the Cité des Arts in Paris) and Anatole Mélot (in residence in South Africa until mid-December) will also join the Brussels studio.

Residencies in South Africa

Since September 2024, SAFFCA has supported a significant number of residencies in South Africa, involving both European and African artists. Among them are Clément Jacques Vossen, Jeffe Debrabandere, Loup Lejeune, Aline Forçain, Sybren Vanoverberghe, and many Southern African artists including Heidi Fourie, Themba Khumalo, Mbali Dhlamini, Bambo Sibiya, Layziehound, Bella Maake, Stephen Langa, Joy Adeboye, and others from South Africa, Uganda, the Democratic Republic of Congo and beyond.

These residencies strengthen SAFFCA's cross-continental network and foster long-term artistic and human exchanges.

Prizes and Salons

The SAFFCA Prize at ARBA was awarded to Thibaud Leplat, who realised his carte blanche exhibition *In Search of the Flower Without Petals* during Art Brussels, including access to the fair's VIP programme.

SAFFCA also organised key group exhibitions:

- SAFFCA Fall Salon 2024, presenting 10 artists including Julien Daffe, Celia Ducaju, Loup Lejeune, Anatole Mélot, Andreas Senoner and others.
- SAFFCA Spring Salon 2025, showcasing another 10 artists including Amandine David, Jeffe De Brabandere, Geneviève Levivier, Sybren Vanoverberghe and Céline Vahsen.
- SAFFCA Fall Salon 2025, bringing together 10 artists including Jiyoung Chu, Aurélie Jourdain, Béatrice le Hodey, Camille Rakotomalala, Carole Solvay and Thérèse Vanneste.

These salons highlight the diversity and quality of the artists supported by SAFFCA.

Public and Audience

The audience for SAFFCA's events is steadily growing. During these SALONS, around 100 guests attend the Private Preview, and 250 to 300 people come to the public openings.

Numerous informal gatherings are also organised at the end of residencies in Brussels, after returns from South Africa, and at the close of long-term studio occupations.

Overall, SAFFCA continues to consolidate its cross-continental presence, deepen engagement with its communities and will pursue the same lines of activity in 2025–2026.

Our leaders & few milestones

SAFFCA is guided on both continents by a Board of Directors made up of personalities committed to the world of art, culture and civil society. Their diversity of expertise and passion for contemporary art ensure the foundation's solidity and vision.

-Ruwadzano "Ruzy" Rusike, Nicola Bird and Pierre Lombart in Africa.

-Kate Fellens, Valentine Himpens-David, Luc de Tillesse, Joachim von Beust, Godefroid de Woelmont and Pierre Lombart in Brussels.

Furthermore, the Friends of SAFFCA.EU fund at the ' Roi Baudouin Foundation ' was created by two great enthusiasts of the plastic and visual arts:

-Bruno Erpicum, a renowned and internationally acclaimed architect.

-André Vossen, a distributor of contemporary furniture and lighting, and a creator of spaces.



- 2015: Creation of SAFFCA in South Africa.
- 2016: First two residencies in St Emilion
- 2017: Exhibition at the Cultural Agency of Périgueux.
- 2018: Exhibition at the Carmel Museum in Libourne and first cross-residency.
- 2019: Exhibition at the MECA in Bordeaux.
- 2020: COVID
- 2021: Opening of SAFFCA.EU in Brussels (17, Abbaye de La Cambre) within a tripartite partnership with ENSAV La Cambre and the Wallonie-Bruxelles Federation.
- 2022: First SAFFCA SALON in Brussels, and first 'Carte Blanche' exhibition as part of the SAFFCA Prize at ARBA and the VIP program of ART Brussels.
- 2023 and 2024: Europe/Africa structuring, new residencies and creation of numerous partnerships.



2025, SAFFCA is celebrating 10 years of activity: a decade marked by the spotlight on African and European artists, numerous cross-residencies, a living collection, a major event in South Africa and SALONS that have become unmissable in Brussels

WHY & HOW TO SUPPORT SAFFCA

By becoming a member or a sponsor, you:

- Associate your image with innovation and cultural diversity.
- Directly support emerging, established or even represented artists.
- Benefit from visibility with a targeted and influential audience (collectors, institutions, patrons, diplomats).
- Participate in an international, unique and prestigious adventure between Brussels, the administrative centre of the European Community, and Africa.
- Enjoy exclusive benefits: private parties, backstage access, artistic hospitality for your clients and employees.

Join us on our 10th anniversary, and let's build the future of SAFFCA together.

'Les Amis de SAFFCA.EU'
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CHRIS SOAL - 2019



SOFAM



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